



# TOMORROW IS ANOTHER DAY

GONE WITH THE WIND / 1939

## IN CONTEXT

GENRE

**Historical romance**

DIRECTOR

**Victor Fleming**

WRITERS

**Sidney Howard (screenplay); Margaret Mitchell (novel)**

STARS

**Vivien Leigh, Clark Gable, Leslie Howard, Olivia de Havilland**

BEFORE

**1915** D. W. Griffith's *The Birth of a Nation* (or *The Clansman*), an epic chronicle of the Civil War, is condemned as racist.

**1933** George Cukor directs *Little Women*, a Civil War era family drama adapted from the novels by Louisa May Alcott.

AFTER

**1948** Vivien Leigh takes the title role in Alexander Korda's adaptation of *Anna Karenina* by Leo Tolstoy.



**N**ow viewed nostalgically as a relic of a long-gone Hollywood, *Gone with the Wind* was itself a rose-tinted portrait of a bygone age. Its preamble pays tribute to a lost America, in a paean to the Old South: "Here in this pretty world, Gallantry took its last bow. Here was the last ever to be seen of Knights and their Ladies Fair, of Master and of Slave. Look for it only in books, for it is no more than a dream remembered, a Civilization gone with the wind..." In 1939, America was still smarting from the grinding poverty of the Great

**Dressing Scarlett** (Vivien Leigh) for the ball, Mammy (Hattie McDaniel) upbraids her newly widowed mistress for trying to ensnare a married man.

Depression, and audiences were swept off their feet by the movie's sheer scale, romance, and blazing color palette.

## Epic adaptation

What is now regarded as a great historical epic was a work of fiction by Margaret Mitchell, whose best-selling Civil War love story was first published in 1936. Before the year